RESOLUTION No. 7243

Proclamation and Recognition of February as Black History Month

RECITALS

A. The Board of Education of Portland Public Schools is committed to fostering a diverse, welcoming and inclusive educational environment that reflects the rich cultural heritage of all people.

B. Black History Month is an annual celebration of the achievements and cultural contributions of African Americans to society and to the history of the United States.

C. Black history is US history.

D. The contributions of African Americans have shaped every aspect of our nation's culture, and progress, from the arts, sciences, politics, and business, to the advancement of civil rights and the fight for social justice.

E. The local community has enriched the diversity of perspective and experience in our District; and the Board of Education desires to recognize and honor the achievements and contributions of African Americans.

F. It is important for students, educators, and the community to recognize and understand the significance of these contributions and how they have influenced and continue to shape the course of history.

G. The Board of Education encourages all adults within the district to engage in educational activities, programs, and events with our students that promote awareness and understanding of Black history, culture, and the experiences of African Americans.

H. This observance offers an opportunity for all of us to learn, reflect, and celebrate the diversity that strengthens our community and nation.

I. Through leadership and practice, Portland Public Schools is dedicated to goals that advance racial justice, especially for Black communities in the Portland Metro area.

RESOLVED

1. The Board of Education of the Portland Public Schools hereby recognizes the month of February 2026 as Black History Month and encourages all educators to commemorate this occasion with appropriate ceremonies, instructional activities, and programs.

2. The Board of Education of Portland Public Schools supports the integration of African American history into the curriculum throughout the entire year, not just during February, in order to provide a comprehensive understanding of the African American experience in the United States.